ELEVEN

OCT 16 1979

# DICK TRACY THE THIRTIES



# TOMMY GUNS AND HARD TIMES

**Chester Gould**

C. 034

**Herb Galewitz, Editor**

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# Chester Gould Reminisces



In mid-September 1921, I received a letter from my dear mother. She said,

"Dear Son. I've just read in the newspaper about those gangsters in Chicago who have been shooting and robbing people for no reason at all, and YOU with $50 in your pocket! Come home at once!"

I had arrived in Chicago with $50 cash in my pocket from my hometown of Pawnee, Oklahoma on September 1, 1921, determined to be a newspaper cartoonist. I was loaded with sample sports cartoons I had drawn for the **Daily Oklahoman** and editorial cartoons from the **Tulsa Democrat**. My aim was to crash the "big-time" cartoon world of Sid Smith's "The Gumps," Frank King's "Gasoline Alley," and Carl Ed's "Harold Teen," all great comics of the time and successful for many years after. But it would be ten years (almost to the day) before I would be able to join that select group.

Well, I hated to disappoint my mother but I didn't go home. To me, Chicago was a beautiful, wonderful, glamorous and **peaceful** place to become a millionaire, and I wouldn't dream of turning back. Becoming a millionaire, however, has proved to be one of the most elusive fantasies of my life.

My first Chicago job was far removed from the world of journalism. Newspaper jobs, as usual, were not plentiful and I wound up stacking groceries in an A&P on Devon Street. Fortunately, I was only there for a month when I heard that an artist on the Chicago **Evening Journal** was sick and I applied and got his job on a temporary basis at a surprising $30 per week. At that time, Chicago had six major daily newspapers, including the **Tribune**, the **Herald-Examiner**, the **Daily News**, the **Journal**, the **American** and the **Post**. Thereafter, I was never without a newspaper job.

While I was not setting the world on fire, I was still doing an occasional comic strip and working with reporters on special pieces that put me close to the action. There was plenty of that in the twenties, sparked by the speakeasies which were supplied by the Beer Barons who were constantly warring with each other in a cacophony of machine guns. Though the average law-abiding citizen was more or less insulated from this unpleasant business, it was being abetted and supported by those who patronized the illegal speak.

Without a doubt, it was this era that planted the idea of DICK TRACY in my head. The revelations of fixed juries, crooked judges, bribery of public officials and cops who looked the other way showed the crying need for a strong representative of law and order who would take an eye for an eye and a tooth for a tooth. Tracy was that man.

Captain Joseph M. Patterson was the founder of the New York **Daily News** and also ran the syndicate that distributed its comic features. In June 1931, I sent him six strips titled "Plainclothes Tracy". After two months, I finally received the following wire:

> BELIEVE PLAINCLOTHES TRACY HAS POSSIBILITIES. SEE ME IN MY TRIBUNE OFFICE THE 20TH.

Needless to say I was prompt for that appointment in the Trib Tower. Patterson changed the

name of the strip to DICK TRACY and handed my submissions back to me with the advice that I would be on the payroll on the fifteenth of next month. Down in the lobby, I bought a cigar and a Coke and broke out into a cold sweat. I had achieved my goal.

Though the work load was awesome, especially in the early years, I can say now that I doubt there is any business that can be equally as satisfying over such a long period of time.

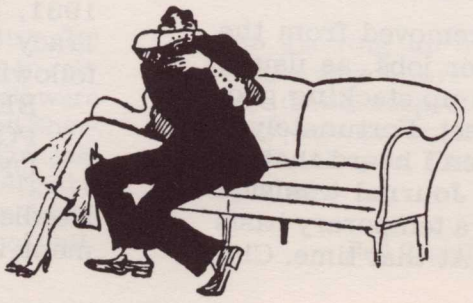
Most newspaper syndicates require eight to thirteen weeks lead time between receipt of material and publication. Because of this, I used to worry that some of my ideas would be stolen before they hit the presses. In order to protect myself, I would date and sign a copy of the drawing, put it into an envelope and mail it to myself. The sealed envelope would then be placed in one of my files for safekeeping.

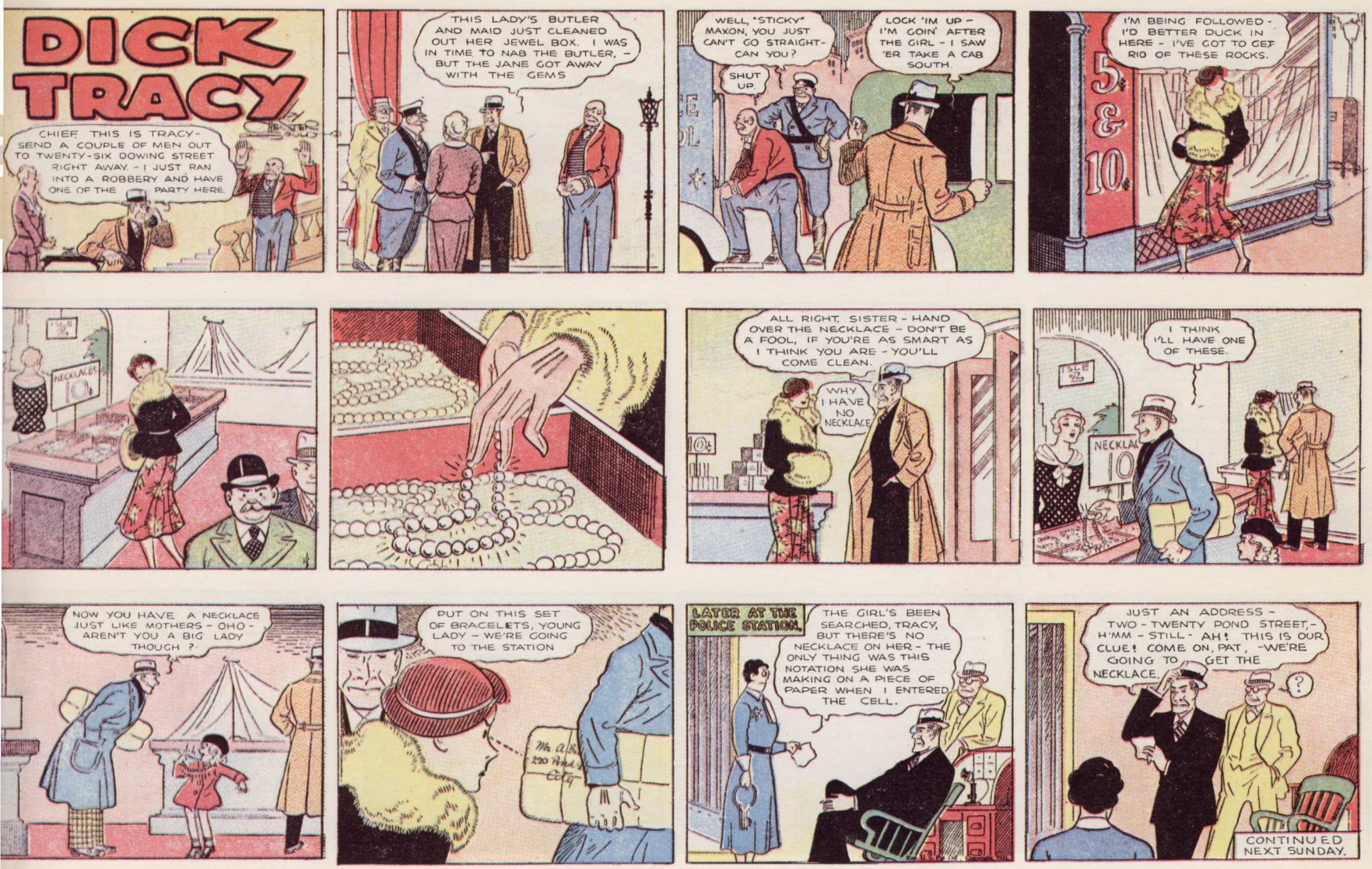
This was especially true of the 2-way wrist radio and TV which I originally sketched on October 17, 1945. As TV was still in its infancy, I used only the radio portion of the device at first. The Army's new walkie-talkie made the wrist radio much more plausible. A few years later, I did incorporate the TV aspect, and it has been a vital part of Tracy's gear to this very day.

Woodstock, Illinois
June, 1978

CHESTER GOULD

I would like to dedicate this volume to my dear, devoted wife, Edna,
who has put up with the vicissitudes of being a cartoonist's mate for nearly 52 years
and has been and still is a constant inspiration.






# CIGARETTE SADIE



# DICK TRACY

ON THE TRAIL OF THE STOLEN NECKLACE, TRACY HASTENS TO THE ADDRESS INDICATED ON A SLIP OF PAPER WHICH WAS FOUND ON A GIRL ACCOMPLICE, AFTER SHE HAD BEEN PLACED IN A CELL FOLLOWING HER CAPTURE BY TRACY IN A FIVE-AND-TEN CENT STORE.....

CHESTER GOULD

THE ADDRESS IS TWO-TWENTY POND STREET, — IT SHOULD BE WITHIN A FEW HOUSES NOW-

-TRACY- YOU'RE A FOOL TO EXPECT TO FIND A STOLEN NECKLACE IN A RESPECTABLE NEIGHBORHOOD LIKE THIS.

LOOK! WHAT'S THAT EXCITEMENT DOWN THE STREET?

OH MY BABY — IS SHE HURT?

NO SHE ISN'T, MISTER - I PUSHED HER OUT OF THE WAY OF THAT TRUCK JUST IN TIME.

COULD WE BE OF ANY ASSISTANCE?

NO, THANK YOU, SIR, -YOU SEE THIS GENTLEMAN HAS JUST SAVED MY LITTLE GIRL'S LIFE.

AND HERE, SIR - IT'S ALL I HAVE ON MY PERSON- -ONLY ABOUT FIFTY DOLLARS, BUT TAKE IT. IT ONLY FEEBLY SHOWS MY APPRECIATION.

THANK YOU VERY MUCH, SIR - AND GOOD DAY.

NO YOU DON'T, THUG- -YOU CAN'T GET AWAY WITH IT THAT EASY.

SEE? HE HAD YOUR CHILD'S NECKLACE IN HIS POCKET - HE TOOK IT FROM AROUND HER NECK.

BUT IT'S ONLY A DIME NECKLACE - WHY, WHAT DOES THIS MEAN?

THIS RESCUE OF YOUR CHILD WAS A FRAME-UP! THIS NECKLACE IS WORTH BETWEEN TEN AND FIFTEEN THOUSAND DOLLARS AND WAS DROPPED INTO A BOX OF TEN-CENT NECKLACES BY A WOMAN THIEF THIS MORNING WHEN SHE WAS CORNERED IN A FIVE-AND-TEN - THEN YOU CAME ALONG AND BOUGHT IT FOR YOUR LITTLE GIRL.

I UNDERSTAND, SIR - AND I REMEMBER I HAPPENED TO BE CARRYING A BUNDLE WITH MY NAME AND ADDRESS ON IT. THAT MUST BE HOW THE THIEF KNEW WHERE I LIVED.

YES - AND SHE NOTIFIED HER ACCOMPLICES BY DROPPING A NOTE FROM HER CELL WINDOW.

LATER

-AND ANOTHER THING, PAT, WHAT WAS IT YOU WERE SAYING THIS AFTERNOON ABOUT FOOLS AND RESPECTABLE NEIGHBORHOODS?

SHUT UP! YOU'VE TALKED ME OUT OF THREE CHECKER GAMES AL READY.

# CIGARETTE SADIE

GEE - THERE'S THAT OLD TIGHTWAD, MR. DEBUNK, OVER THERE - HE HASN'T BOUGHT A PACKAGE OF CIGARETTES FROM ME SINCE HE'S BEEN COMING HERE.

CIGARS, CIGARETTES-

HEY-

NOW, LOOK! YOU'VE SPILLED THAT WATER ON MY SMOKES AND RUINED THEM-

HAVE YOU EVER TRIED "PLUCKY HUNKS"? THEY'RE ONLY THIRTY CENTS-

CIGARS - CIGARETTES-

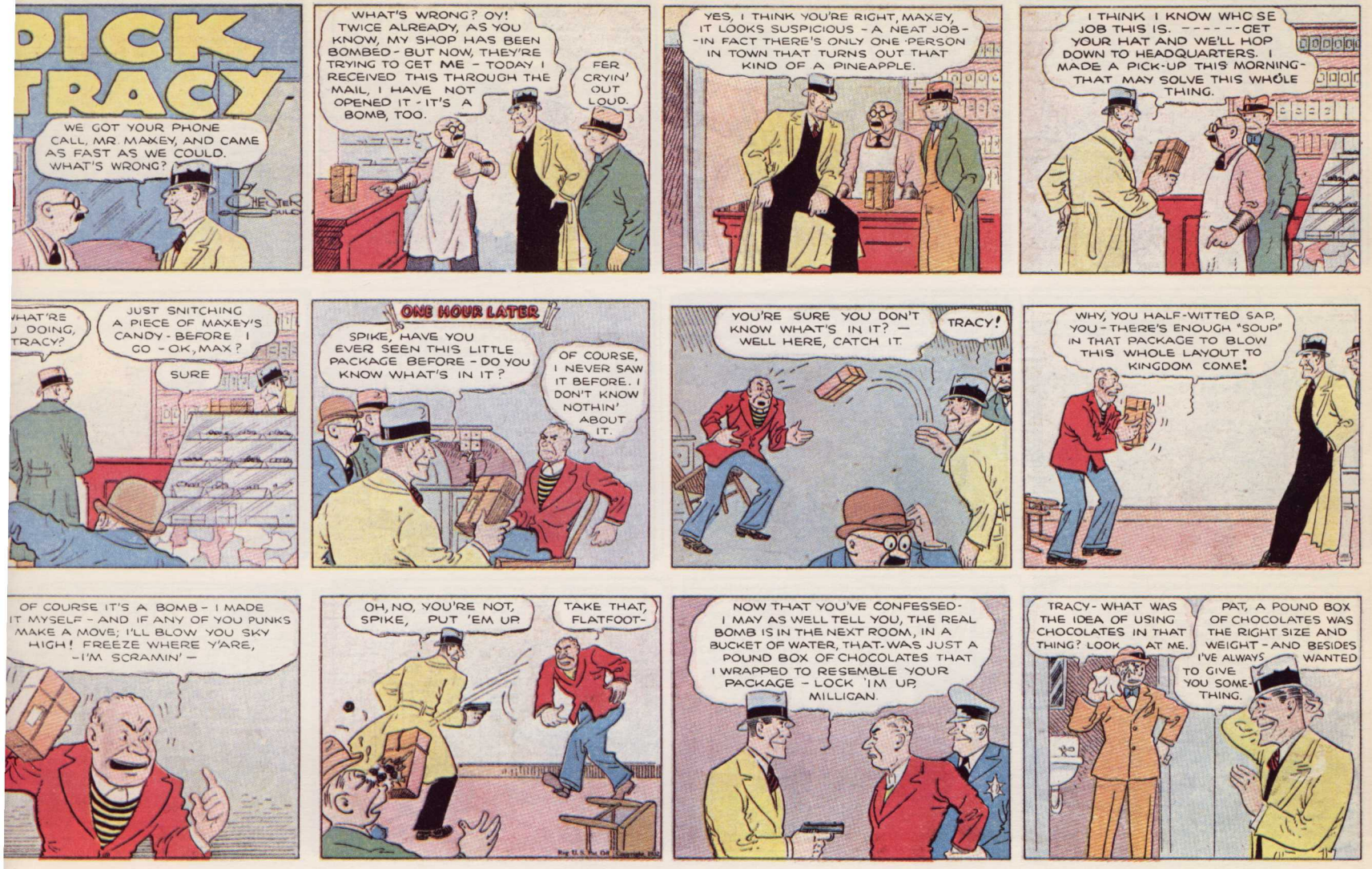
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HERE'S ANOTHER STAMP OF OUR GANGSTER-GETTING ACE DICK TRACY

CUT 'IM OUT, KIDS.

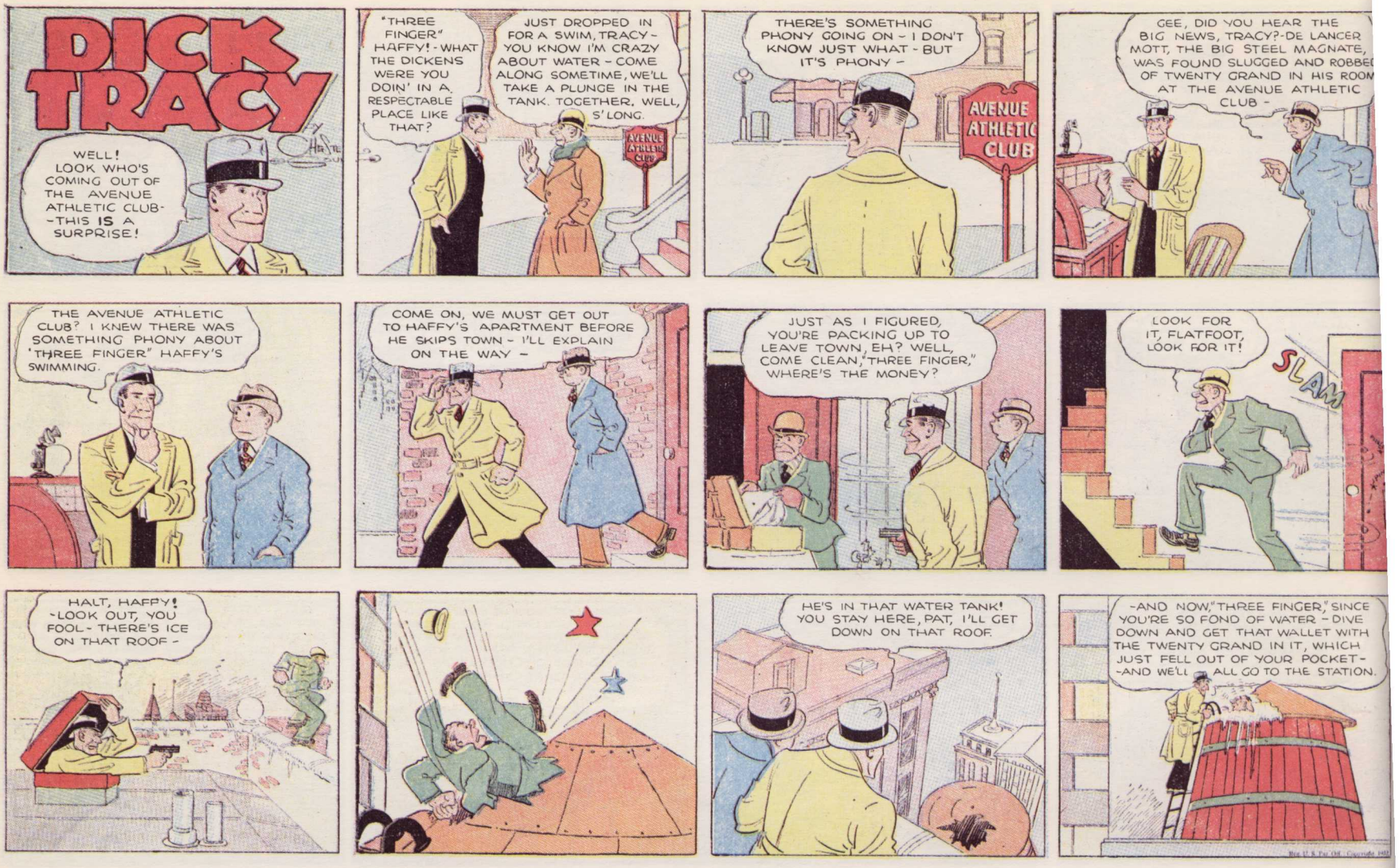
DICK TRACY

CHESTER GOULD



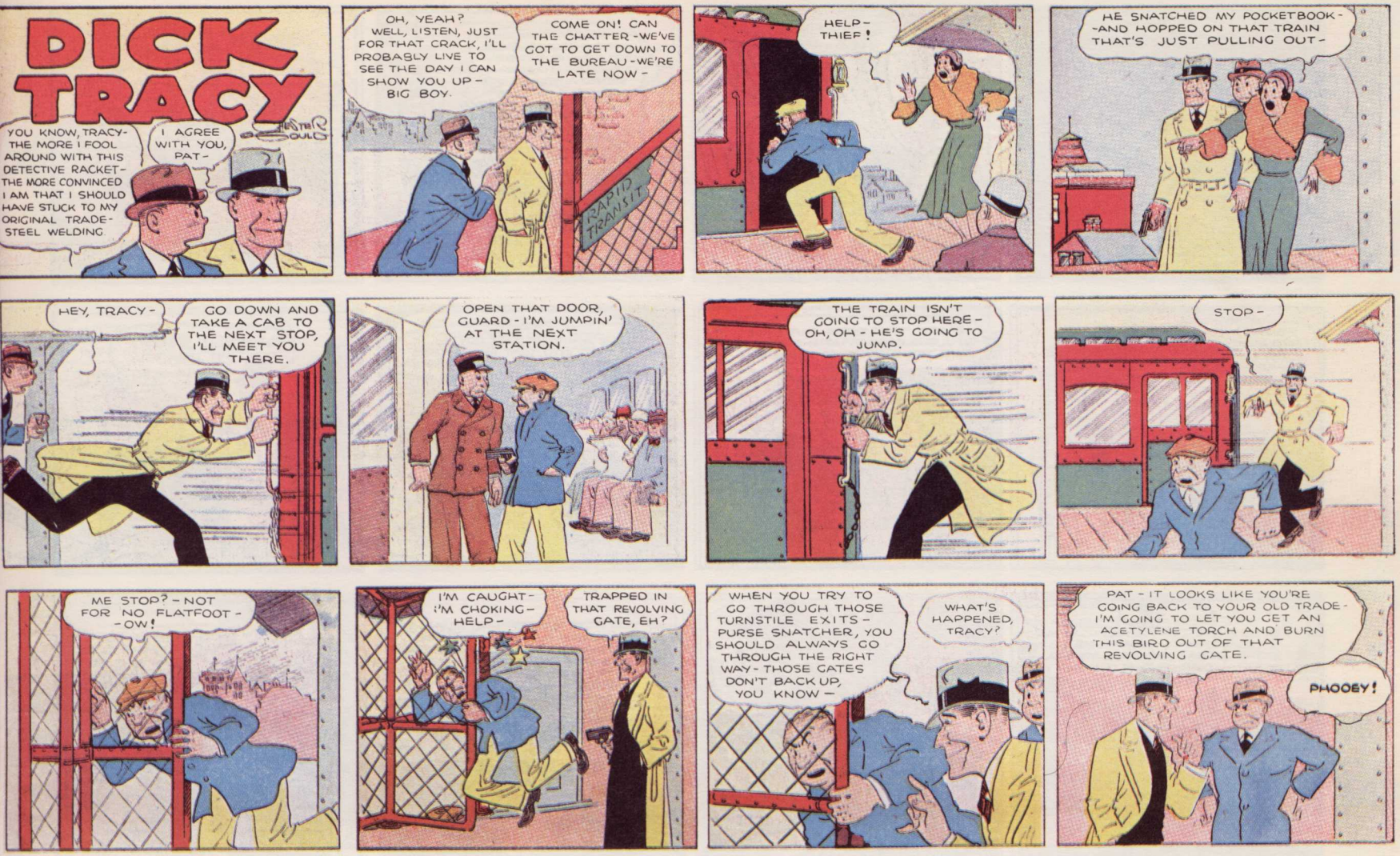

# CIGARETTE SADIE






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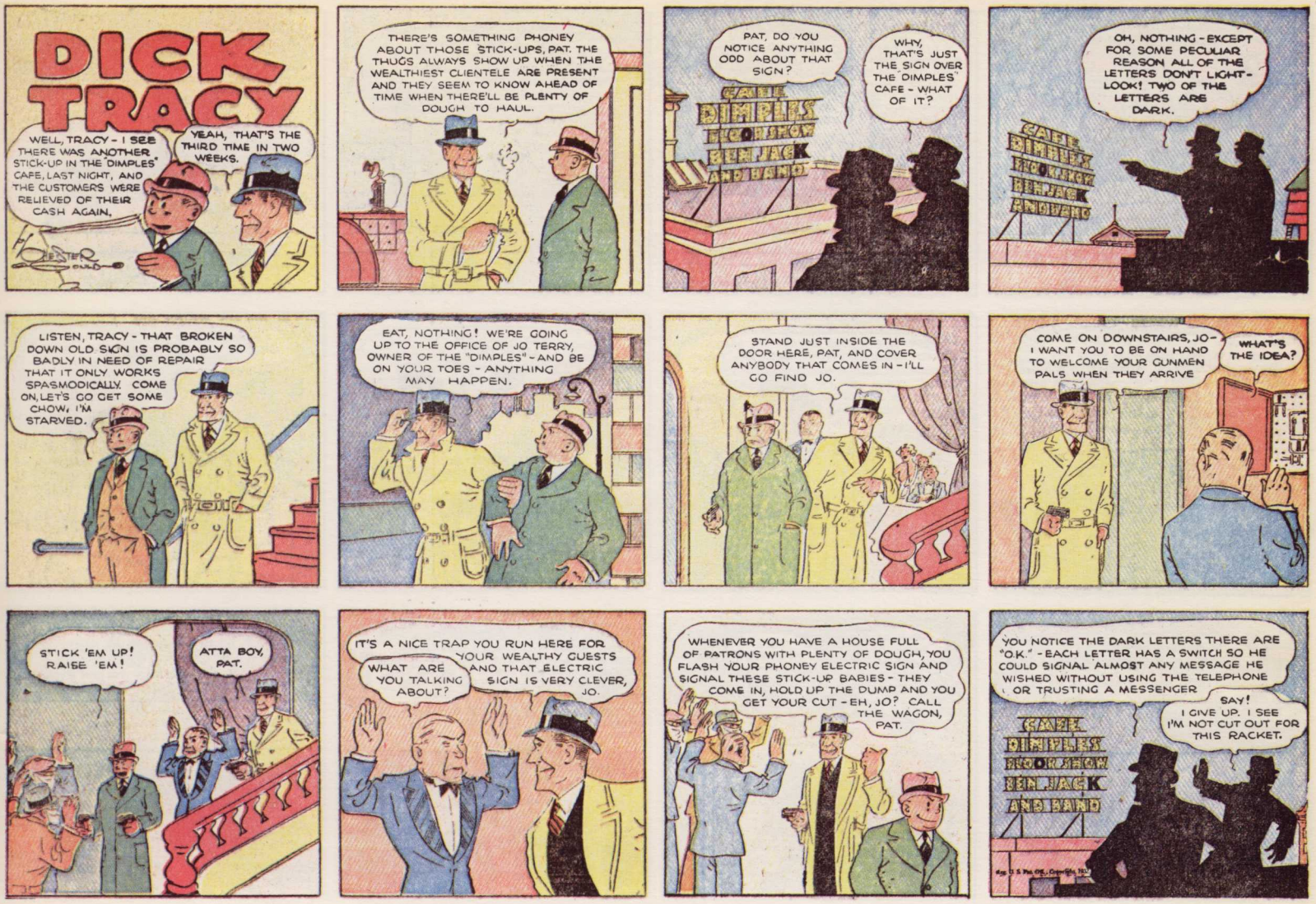

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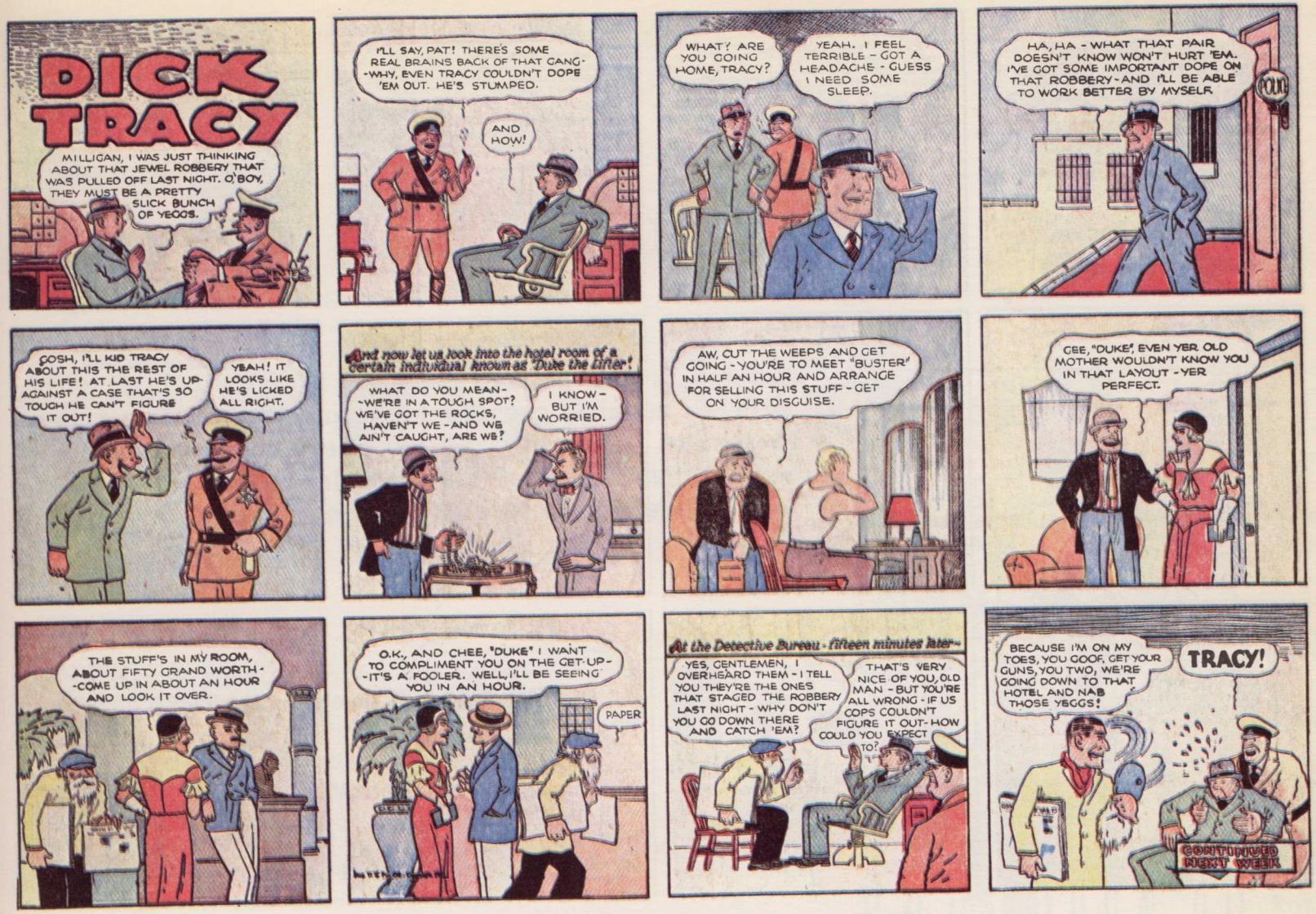

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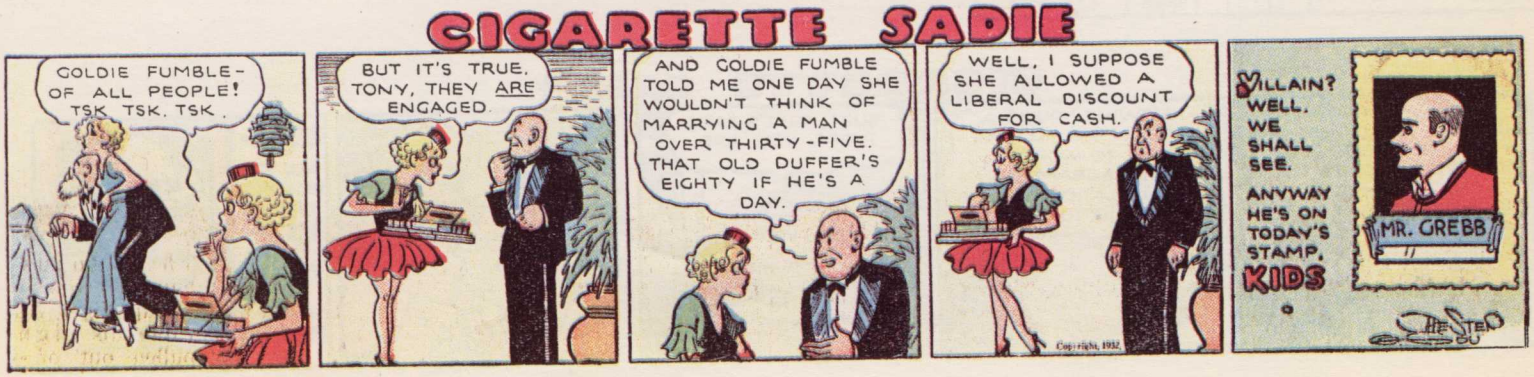





# CIGARETTE SADIE




DICK TRACY
MILLIGAN, I WAS JUST THINKING ABOUT THAT JEWEL ROBBERY THAT WAS PULLED OFF LAST NIGHT. O'BOY, THEY MUST BE A PRETTY SLICK BUNCH OF YEGGS.
I'LL SAY, PAT! THERE'S SOME REAL BRAINS BACK OF THAT GANG--WHY, EVEN TRACY COULDN'T DOPE 'EM OUT. HE'S STUMPED.
AND HOW!
WHAT? ARE YOU GOING HOME, TRACY?
YEAH. I FEEL TERRIBLE - GOT A HEADACHE - GUESS I NEED SOME SLEEP.
HA, HA - WHAT THAT PAIR DOESN'T KNOW WON'T HURT 'EM. I'VE GOT SOME IMPORTANT DOPE ON THAT ROBBERY - AND I'LL BE ABLE TO WORK BETTER BY MYSELF
POUF!
GOSH, I'LL KID TRACY ABOUT THIS THE REST OF HIS LIFE! AT LAST HE'S UP AGAINST A CASE THAT'S SO TOUGH HE CAN'T FIGURE IT OUT!
YEAH! IT LOOKS LIKE HE'S LICKED ALL RIGHT.
And now let us look into the hotel room of a certain individual known as "Duke the Lifter"!
WHAT DO YOU MEAN--WE'RE IN A TOUGH SPOT? WE'VE GOT THE ROCKS, HAVEN'T WE - AND WE AIN'T CAUGHT, ARE WE?
I KNOW - BUT I'M WORRIED.
AW, CUT THE WEEPS AND GET GOING - YOU'RE TO MEET "BUSTER" IN HALF AN HOUR AND ARRANGE FOR SELLING THIS STUFF - GET ON YOUR DISGUISE.
GEE, "DUKE", EVEN YER OLD MOTHER WOULDN'T KNOW YOU IN THAT LAYOUT - YER PERFECT.
THE STUFF'S IN MY ROOM, ABOUT FIFTY GRAND WORTH--COME UP IN ABOUT AN HOUR AND LOOK IT OVER.
O.K., AND CHEE, "DUKE" I WANT TO COMPLIMENT YOU ON THE GET-UP--IT'S A FOOLER. WELL, I'LL BE SEEING YOU IN AN HOUR.
PAPER
At the Detective Bureau - fifteen minutes later--
YES, GENTLEMEN, I OVERHEARD THEM - I TELL YOU THEY'RE THE ONES THAT STAGED THE ROBBERY LAST NIGHT - WHY DON'T YOU GO DOWN THERE AND CATCH 'EM?
THAT'S VERY NICE OF YOU, OLD MAN - BUT YOU'RE ALL WRONG - IF US COPS COULDN'T FIGURE IT OUT - HOW COULD YOU EXPECT TO?
BECAUSE I'M ON MY TOES, YOU GOOF. GET YOUR GUNS, YOU TWO, WE'RE GOING DOWN TO THAT HOTEL AND NAB THOSE YEGGS!
TRACY!
CONTINUED NEXT WEEK

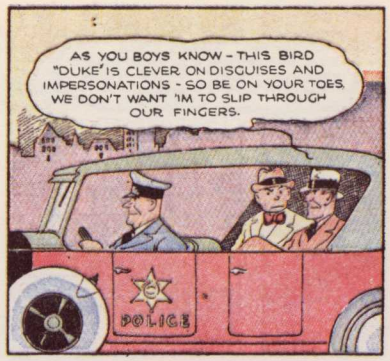

CIGARETTE SADIE
GOLDIE FUMBLE-OF ALL PEOPLE! TSK. TSK. TSK.
BUT IT'S TRUE. TONY, THEY ARE ENGAGED
AND GOLDIE FUMBLE TOLD ME ONE DAY SHE WOULDN'T THINK OF MARRYING A MAN OVER THIRTY-FIVE. THAT OLD DUFFER'S EIGHTY IF HE'S A DAY.
WELL, I SUPPOSE SHE ALLOWED A LIBERAL DISCOUNT FOR CASH.
Copyright, 1932
VILLAIN? WELL. WE SHALL SEE.
ANYWAY HE'S ON TODAY'S STAMP, KIDS
MR. GREBB

# DICK TRACY

DISGUISING HIMSELF AS A BE-WHISKERED NEWSPAPER HAWKER, DICK TRACY LEARNS THE IDENTITY OF THE PARTY WHO COMMITTED THE HUGE JEWEL ROBBERY. HE ALSO LEARNS THE WHEREABOUTS OF THE STOLEN GEMS.











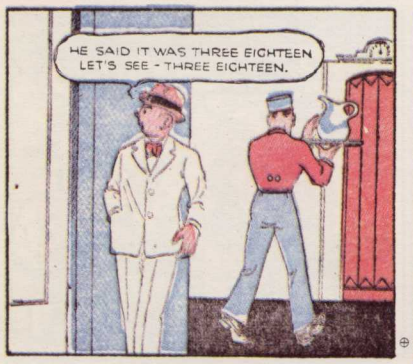






















# CIGARETTE SADIE



# THE TEXIE GARCIA CAPER

NOVEMBER 16, 1931—DECEMBER 30, 1931

**Big Boy**'s gun moll is forced to take the rap for her boss, but **Texie,** a ringer for actress Dolores Del Rio, has a blackmailing ace up her sleeve. In an act of faith, **Dick Tracy** fulfills his pledge to avenge the murder of **Tess Trueheart**'s father by disposing of killer **"Crutch."**

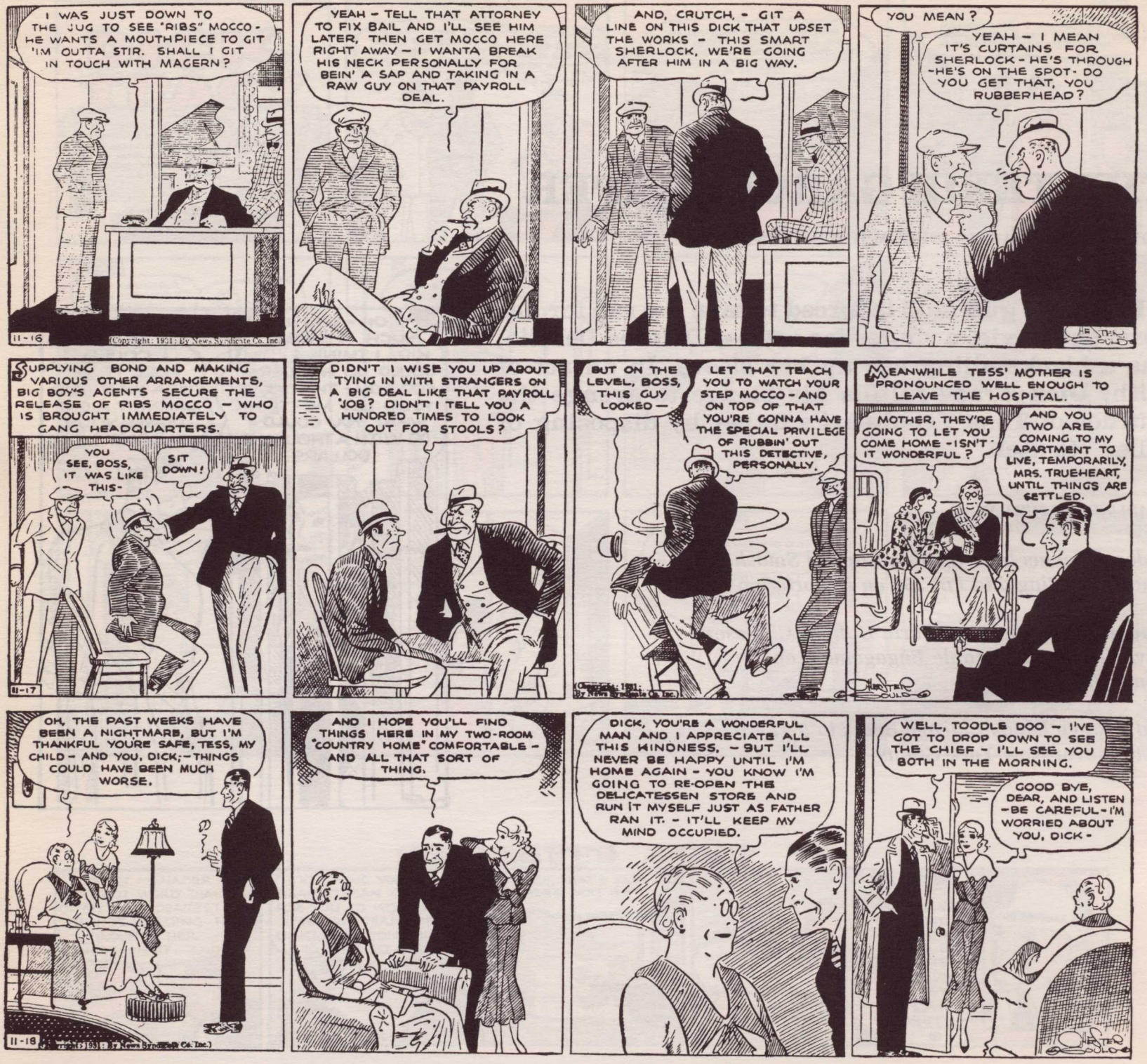



*HEADLINES OF THE DAY*

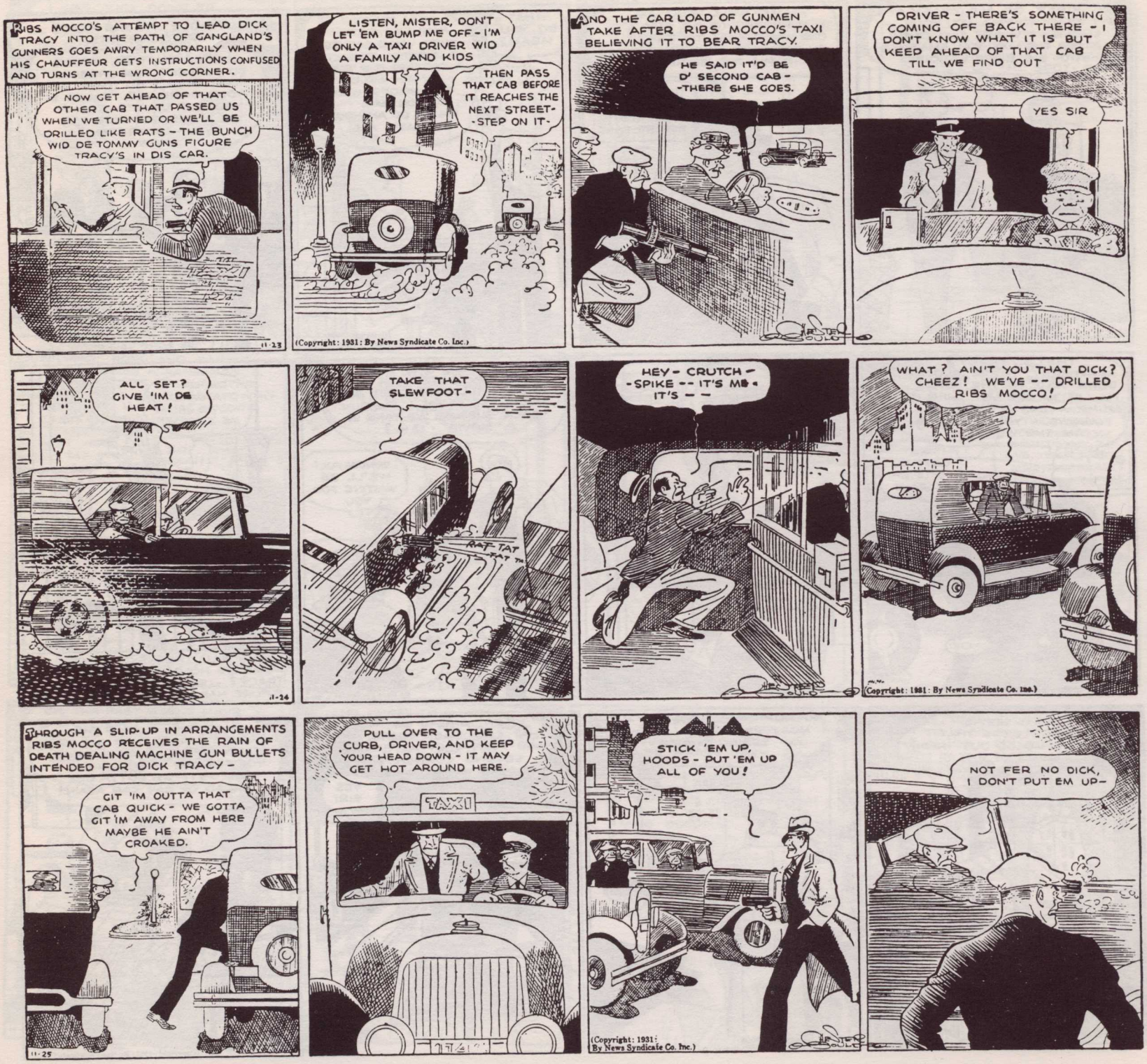
*Federal Agents Investigating Capone Smash Smuggling Ring and Put 250 on Deportation Skids*

*Japanese Army in Manchuria Defeats Chinese Cavalry in Considerable Engagement on Nonni River*

*Red Grange Leads Chicago Bears to a 12 – 6 Victory over New York Giants*


I WAS JUST DOWN TO THE JUG TO SEE "RIBS" MOCCO - HE WANTS A MOUTHPIECE TO GIT 'IM OUTTA STIR. SHALL I GIT IN TOUCH WITH MAGERN?
YEAH - TELL THAT ATTORNEY TO FIX BAIL AND I'LL SEE HIM LATER, THEN GET MOCCO HERE RIGHT AWAY - I WANTA BREAK HIS NECK PERSONALLY FOR BEIN' A SAP AND TAKING IN A RAW GUY ON THAT PAYROLL DEAL.
AND, CRUTCH, - GIT A LINE ON THIS DICK THAT UPSET THE WORKS - THIS SMART SHERLOCK, WE'RE GOING AFTER HIM IN A BIG WAY.
YOU MEAN?
YEAH - I MEAN IT'S CURTAINS FOR SHERLOCK - HE'S THROUGH -HE'S ON THE SPOT- DO YOU GET THAT, YOU RUBBERHEAD?
11-16
(Copyright: 1951: By News Syndicate Co. Inc.)
SUPPLYING BOND AND MAKING VARIOUS OTHER ARRANGEMENTS, BIG BOY'S AGENTS SECURE THE RELEASE OF RIBS MOCCO - WHO IS BROUGHT IMMEDIATELY TO GANG HEADQUARTERS.
YOU SEE, BOSS, IT WAS LIKE THIS-
SIT DOWN!
11-17
DIDN'T I WISE YOU UP ABOUT TYING IN WITH STRANGERS ON A BIG DEAL LIKE THAT PAYROLL JOB? DIDN'T I TELL YOU A HUNDRED TIMES TO LOOK OUT FOR STOOLS?
BUT ON THE LEVEL, BOSS, THIS GUY LOOKED—
LET THAT TEACH YOU TO WATCH YOUR STEP MOCCO - AND ON TOP OF THAT YOU'RE GONNA HAVE THE SPECIAL PRIVILEGE OF RUBBIN' OUT THIS DETECTIVE, PERSONALLY.
MEANWHILE TESS' MOTHER IS PRONOUNCED WELL ENOUGH TO LEAVE THE HOSPITAL.
MOTHER, THEY'RE GOING TO LET YOU COME HOME - ISN'T IT WONDERFUL?
AND YOU TWO ARE COMING TO MY APARTMENT TO LIVE, TEMPORARILY, MRS. TRUEHEART, UNTIL THINGS ARE SETTLED.
OH, THE PAST WEEKS HAVE BEEN A NIGHTMARE, BUT I'M THANKFUL YOU'RE SAFE, TESS, MY CHILD - AND YOU, DICK; - THINGS COULD HAVE BEEN MUCH WORSE.
11-18
AND I HOPE YOU'LL FIND THINGS HERE IN MY TWO-ROOM "COUNTRY HOME" COMFORTABLE - AND ALL THAT SORT OF THING.
DICK, YOU'RE A WONDERFUL MAN AND I APPRECIATE ALL THIS KINDNESS, - BUT I'LL NEVER BE HAPPY UNTIL I'M HOME AGAIN - YOU KNOW I'M GOING TO RE-OPEN THE DELICATESSEN STORE AND RUN IT MYSELF JUST AS FATHER RAN IT. - IT'LL KEEP MY MIND OCCUPIED.
WELL, TOODLE DOO - I'VE GOT TO DROP DOWN TO SEE THE CHIEF - I'LL SEE YOU BOTH IN THE MORNING.
GOOD BYE, DEAR, AND LISTEN -BE CAREFUL- I'M WORRIED ABOUT YOU, DICK-


FIRST OF ALL, TRACY, I WANT TO TELL YOU YOUR LIFE ISN'T WORTH TWO CENTS AFTER THE WAY YOU SMASHED INTO BIG BOY'S LADDIES.
11-19
YEAH?- WELL WHAT AM I SUPPOSED TO DO, BUY A ONE WAY TICKET TO BRAZIL? BY THE WAY, WHAT ABOUT MOCCO AND HIS PAL, SPIKE?
THEY'VE BEEN OUT ON BOND SINCE NIGHT BEFORE LAST.
WHAT DO YOU MEAN?
WHY, THIRTY MINUTES AFTER THEY WERE LOCKED UP, BIG BOY CONTACTED A CERTAIN BIG SHOT, -AND- WELL THE HOODS WERE OUT ON BAIL INSIDE OF AN HOUR, THAT'S ALL.
(Copyright: 1931: By News Syndicate Co. Inc.)
MEANWHILE AT BIG BOY'S HEADQUARTERS.
NOW LISTEN, RIBS, HERE'S OUR SCHEME FOR ERASING THAT DICK, - GIT THIS IN YOUR DOME, KID, 'CAUSE IF YOU SLIP UP IT'S GONNA BE A ONE WAY RIDE FOR YOU - UN'ERSTAN? -NOW-
THAT'S TRACY'S APARTMENT THREE BLOCKS DOWN AND TO THE LEFT I'LL LET 'IM SEE ME, THEN I'LL JUMP A CAB - WHEN HE FOLLOWS - YOU GUYS GIVE 'IM THE WORKS -
WE GOTCHA, STUPID- SCRAM!
11-20
AND LISTEN, TESS, I DON'T THINK MY DATE WITH THE CHIEF WILL LAST OVER AN HOUR, - SO WHEN I FLAG BACK SUPPOSE WE TAKE IN A MOVIE - O.K.?
WONDERFUL! WE'LL BE WAITING FOR YOU.
Copyright: 1931: By News Syndicate Co. Inc.
DA DA D'YA DA DA- YOU'RE DRIVIN' ME CRAZY.♪
WHAT WILL THE NEXT FEW MOMENTS HOLD IN STORE FOR DICK TRACY? -UPON THIS DEPENDS THE FUTURE HAPPINESS OF THREE PEOPLE.
AM I SEEING THINGS OR IS THAT RIBS MOCCO OUT THERE?
11-21
NO-NO- OF COURSE NOT - I MUST BE PLENTY JUMPY- I'M SEEING THINGS - TAXI -
KEEP AHEAD OF THAT CAB BACK THERE, AND TURN LEFT AT THE SECOND CORNER.
YES SIR!
WHAT TH- I SAID THE SECOND CORNER, NOT THE FIRST, YOU NIT-WIT - I OUGHTA DRILL YOU FER DIS! - AND THEN STEP ON IT - WE GOTTA GET AHEAD OF DAT CAB AGAIN!
(Copyright: 1931: By News Syndicate Co. Inc.)


RIBS MOCCO'S ATTEMPT TO LEAD DICK TRACY INTO THE PATH OF GANGLAND'S GUNNERS GOES AWRY TEMPORARILY WHEN HIS CHAUFFEUR GETS INSTRUCTIONS CONFUSED AND TURNS AT THE WRONG CORNER.
NOW GET AHEAD OF THAT OTHER CAB THAT PASSED US WHEN WE TURNED OR WE'LL BE DRILLED LIKE RATS - THE BUNCH WID DE TOMMY GUNS FIGURE TRACY'S IN DIS CAR.
11-23
LISTEN, MISTER, DON'T LET 'EM BUMP ME OFF - I'M ONLY A TAXI DRIVER WID A FAMILY AND KIDS
THEN PASS THAT CAB BEFORE IT REACHES THE NEXT STREET - STEP ON IT -
(Copyright: 1931: By News Syndicate Co. Inc.)
AND THE CAR LOAD OF GUNMEN TAKE AFTER RIBS MOCCO'S TAXI BELIEVING IT TO BEAR TRACY.
HE SAID IT'D BE D' SECOND CAB - - THERE SHE GOES.
DRIVER - THERE'S SOMETHING COMING OFF BACK THERE - I DON'T KNOW WHAT IT IS BUT KEEP AHEAD OF THAT CAB TILL WE FIND OUT
YES SIR
ALL SET? GIVE 'IM DE HEAT!
11-24
TAKE THAT SLEWFOOT -
RAT-TAT
HEY - CRUTCH - - SPIKE -- IT'S ME - IT'S - -
WHAT? AIN'T YOU THAT DICK? CHEEZ! WE'VE -- DRILLED RIBS MOCCO!
(Copyright: 1931: By News Syndicate Co. Inc.)
THROUGH A SLIP-UP IN ARRANGEMENTS RIBS MOCCO RECEIVES THE RAIN OF DEATH DEALING MACHINE GUN BULLETS INTENDED FOR DICK TRACY -
GIT 'IM OUTTA THAT CAB QUICK - WE GOTTA GIT 'IM AWAY FROM HERE MAYBE HE AIN'T CROAKED.
11-25
PULL OVER TO THE CURB, DRIVER, AND KEEP YOUR HEAD DOWN - IT MAY GET HOT AROUND HERE.
TAXI
STICK 'EM UP, HOODS - PUT 'EM UP ALL OF YOU!
(Copyright: 1931: By News Syndicate Co. Inc.)
NOT FER NO DICK, I DON'T PUT EM UP -